RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

15 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 6:50 AM, Thursday 15 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 183 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Halted** · 59 cancelled

Riyadh halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, about 4,890 minutes at 7:00 AM; Dammam halted since 5:14 AM, about 106 minutes; NOTAM A3604/26 to 12:00 AM Sunday 18 Oct

INCIDENT SUMMARY

1 What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, about 4,890 minutes at 7:00 AM; NOTAM A3604/26 keeps it closed until 12:00 AM Sunday 18 Oct**.
- No Riyadh takeoff or landing in the last hour; 183 flights cancelled for Thursday (24% of scheduled).
- Dammam halted since 5:14 AM, about 106 minutes at 7:00 AM: no takeoff or landing since then; 59 flights cancelled today.
- Coalition says a drone was intercepted and destroyed over the Eastern Region (CONFIRMED, SPA / Al Ekhbariya).
- Saudi embassy in Bahrain is helping citizens with disrupted flights get home, including by road (CONFIRMED, Al Ekhbariya).

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (4881 min).

183	0/0	1
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

HALTED

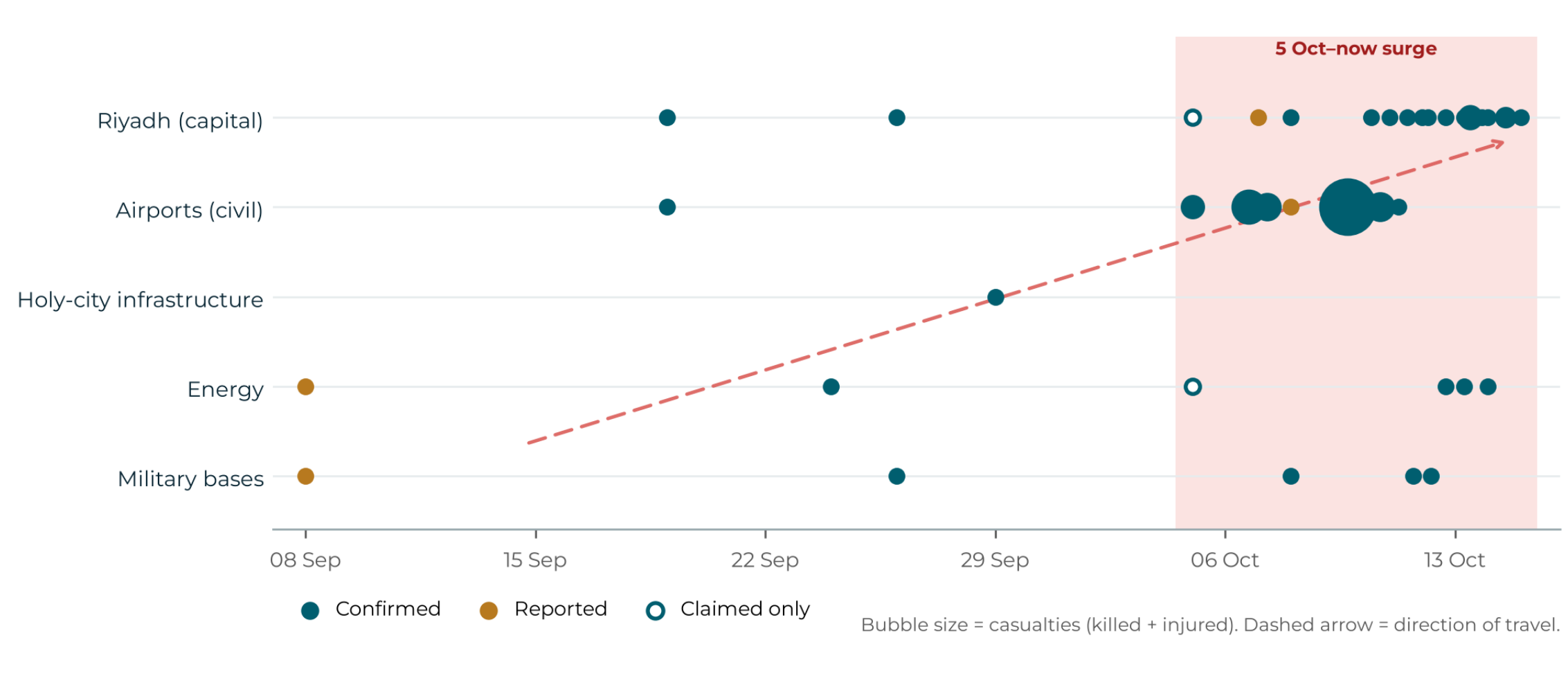
No takeoff or landing since 5:14 AM (96 min).

59	0/0	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday (4,710 min at 4:00 AM). Dammam now halted: no takeoff or landing since flynas XY832 from Amman landed at 2:42 AM (78 min at 4:00 AM); last takeoff Saudia SV1131 to Jeddah at 1:32 AM. No new attack, interception or Civil Defense alert from official Saudi accounts since 2:00 AM.

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 15 OCT



38 sourced events since 8 September (32 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: UAV intercepted and destroyed in Eastern Region (4:13 AM) (15 Oct, Coalition spokesman / SPA; none reported (intercept)). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

2 Riyadh still halted; Dammam halted since 2:42 AM; no new official attack reports since 2:00 AM

Checked at 6:50 AM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: Coalition intercepted and destroyed a drone over the Eastern Region**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:59 AM** · published 5:59 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 6:50 AM

Al Ekhbariya relayed the coalition statement that a drone was intercepted and destroyed over the Eastern Region. No casualties reported in the coalition line.

CONFIRMED **Saudi embassy in Bahrain helping citizens with disrupted flights get home, including by road**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:15 AM** · published 5:15 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 6:50 AM

Al Ekhbariya reported ongoing efforts by the Saudi embassy in Bahrain to help Saudi citizens whose flights were affected return home, including arranging land transport.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed over the Eastern Region**
SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **4:13 AM** · published 4:13 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (Coalition spokesman, Arabic; SPA English 4:43 AM); checked 6:50 AM

The Coalition spokesman said a drone (UAV) was intercepted and destroyed over the Eastern Region; first posted in Arabic at 4:13 AM by the Coalition spokesman and SPA, English release from SPA at 4:43 AM. No casualties or debris damage reported so far.

CONFIRMED **Yemeni armed forces say about 1,250 Houthi fighters neutralised and more than 460 militia vehicles destroyed**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **2:35 AM** · published 2:35 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 6:50 AM

Al Ekhbariya reported that Yemen's armed forces said about 1,250 Houthi fighters had been neutralised and more than 460 militia military vehicles destroyed; the figures are the Yemeni forces' own and were not independently verified. No new attack, interception, Civil Defense alert or airport statement was posted by official Saudi accounts between 2:00 and 3:00 AM.

CONFIRMED **Islamic Affairs Minister praises the armed forces' sacrifices in protecting the Kingdom**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **1:45 AM** · published 1:45 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 6:50 AM

Minister of Islamic Affairs Sheikh Dr. Abdullatif Al-Sheikh said the Kingdom will remain a nation of monotheism and pure creed, and that it values the great sacrifices of the armed forces in protecting the homeland. No new attack, interception or airport statement was posted by official Saudi accounts between 1:00 and 2:00 AM.

CONFIRMED **Saudi UN envoy in Geneva: Kingdom condemns repeated Houthi attacks and affirms its right to protect its sovereignty**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **12:34 AM** · published 12:34 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 12:58 AM

Abdulmohsen bin Khuthaila, the Kingdom's permanent representative to the UN in Geneva, said Saudi Arabia condemns the Houthi terrorist militia's repeated attacks on its territory and affirms its right to protect its sovereignty and the security of citizens and residents under international law.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya correspondent in Yemen: 'Dawn of Yemen' operation escalating on Taiz, Marib and Lahj fronts**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **12:25 AM** · published 12:25 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 12:58 AM

Saudi state broadcaster Al Ekhbariya's Yemen correspondent reported the 'Dawn of Yemen' operation is escalating quickly, with 24 hours of fighting on the northern and western fronts of Taiz city. He said the Houthi militia fired more than 1,000 mortar rounds at Jabal Han in 24 hours without a breakthrough. Battlefield claims are not independently verified.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport (KKIA) tells passengers to check flight status with their airline**
King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **12:24 AM** · published 12:24 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account reply, Arabic, translated); checked 12:58 AM

Replying to a passenger, King Khalid International Airport said that for flight status or any updates, travellers should contact their airline, as the carrier is responsible for the flight. No reopening time was given.

CONFIRMED **SPA: Bahrain condemns Houthi attacks on the Kingdom and urges decisive Security Council measures**
SPA (@Spa_Eng, @SPAregions) · **11:56 PM Wed** · published 11:56 PM AST Wed 14 Oct (SPA English; Arabic 10:20 PM); checked 12:58 AM

The Saudi Press Agency reported that Bahrain strongly condemned the Houthi terrorist militia's attacks on Saudi Arabia and urged the UN Security Council to take decisive measures. It adds to the string of foreign condemnations carried by SPA since the airport strikes.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: Houthi attack fallout reaches a Riyadh family home — child's name on a door, shrapnel and a prayer rug**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **11:22 PM Wed** · published 11:22 PM AST Wed 14 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 11:34 PM

Al Ekhbariya correspondent Abdullah Al-Ruwais reported from a Riyadh home where Houthi attack fallout reached a civilian family: a child's name and a small heart on a bedroom door, shrapnel marks in the living room, and a prayer rug. The report ties the damage to Houthi assaults over Riyadh skies. No new casualty figure in the post.

CONFIRMED **SPA: Italian foreign minister condemns Houthi attacks in phone call with Saudi foreign minister**
SPA (@Spa_Eng) / Foreign Ministry (@KSAmofaEN) / Al Ekhbariya · **10:12 PM Wed** · published 10:12 PM AST Wed 14 Oct (SPA English); MOFA EN and Al Ekhbariya ~9:39–9:41 PM; checked 11:34 PM

SPA English reported that Foreign Minister Prince Faisal bin Farhan received a phone call from Italy's foreign minister condemning Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia. The Foreign Ministry and Al Ekhbariya also noted the call; Al Ekhbariya said Italy thanked the Kingdom for efforts to keep residents safe.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense: debris from intercepted Houthi ballistic missile injured a resident in Riyadh and damaged a home and a vehicle**
SPA (@Spa_Eng) / Saudi Civil Defense, via Arab News and Saudi Gazette · **4:01 PM Wed** · published 4:01 PM AST Wed 14 Oct (SPA English); Arab News 4:09 PM, Saudi Gazette 3:57 PM; checked 12:58 AM

Saudi Civil Defense said falling debris from the ballistic missile intercepted over Riyadh on Wednesday injured a resident of Arab nationality and caused minor damage to a house and a vehicle. This follows the coalition's 10:43 AM statement that the missile was intercepted and destroyed.

CLAIM **Houthi spokesman claims missile and drone strikes on Aramco Dhahran, King Khalid airport and a Riyadh refinery**
Houthi military spokesman Yahya Saree, via Roya News / RT / MTV · **11:50 AM Wed** · first posts 11:50 AM–12:05 PM AST Wed 14 Oct; checked 2:55 PM

Houthi spokesman Yahya Saree claimed ballistic missiles, cruise missiles and drones were fired at Aramco in Dhahran, King Khalid International Airport and the Aramco refinery in Riyadh, and threatened more attacks on Saudi airports and oil sites. Saudi officials reported intercepts and a limited Dhahran fire overnight; no new damage at the airport has been officially confirmed.

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

3 Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (4881 min).

183	4:11 AM	—	0	1
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
83 departures + 100 arrivals, 24% of 749 scheduled.	SV1523 to Tabuk, 1598 min before 6:50 AM.	None on the board.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Qassim.

Cancellation basis: *Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 6:50 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 182 at 6:50 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	83	100	183	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	83 (22%)	99 (27%)	182	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	0 (0%)	0 (0%)	0	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	3 (100%)	21 (100%)	24	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	0 of 75	0 of 77	0 of 152	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	1	1	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	11	17	28	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	236	217	453	FR24 stats panel

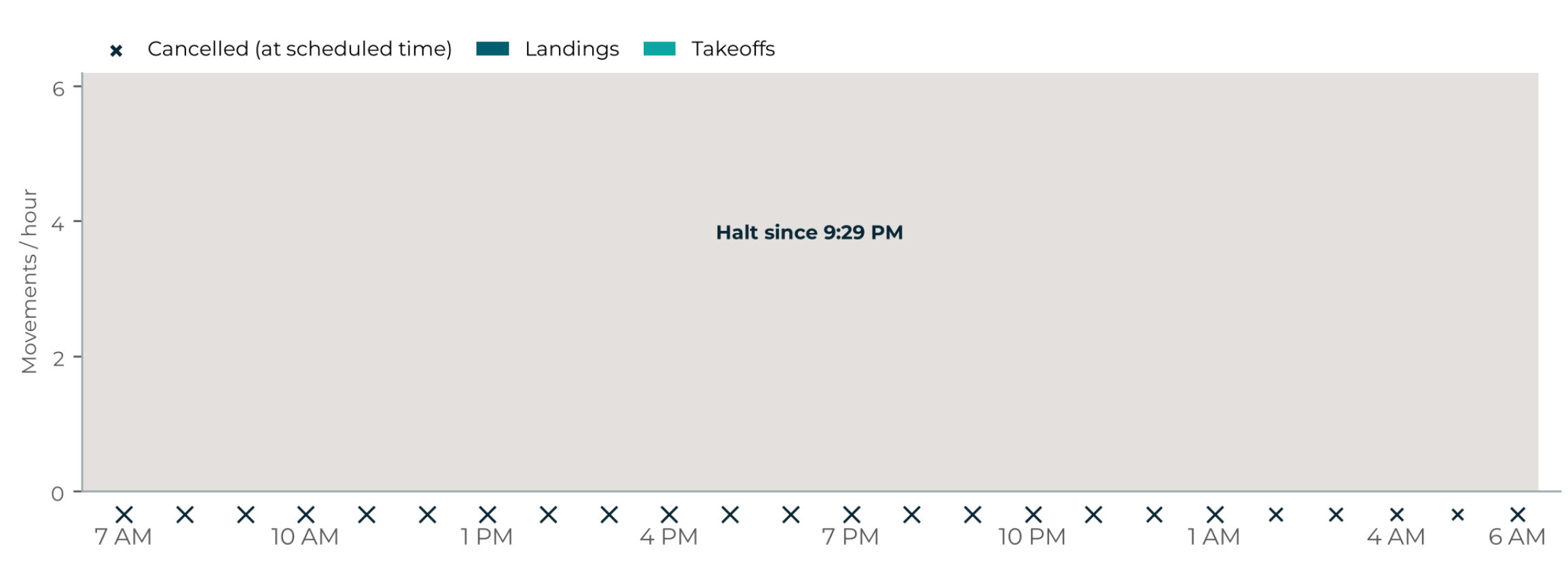
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	48
Riyadh Air	22
flynas	18
Qatar Airways	15
flyadeal	11

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Jeddah	25
Madinah	22
Doha	15
Bahrain	14
Dubai	12

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



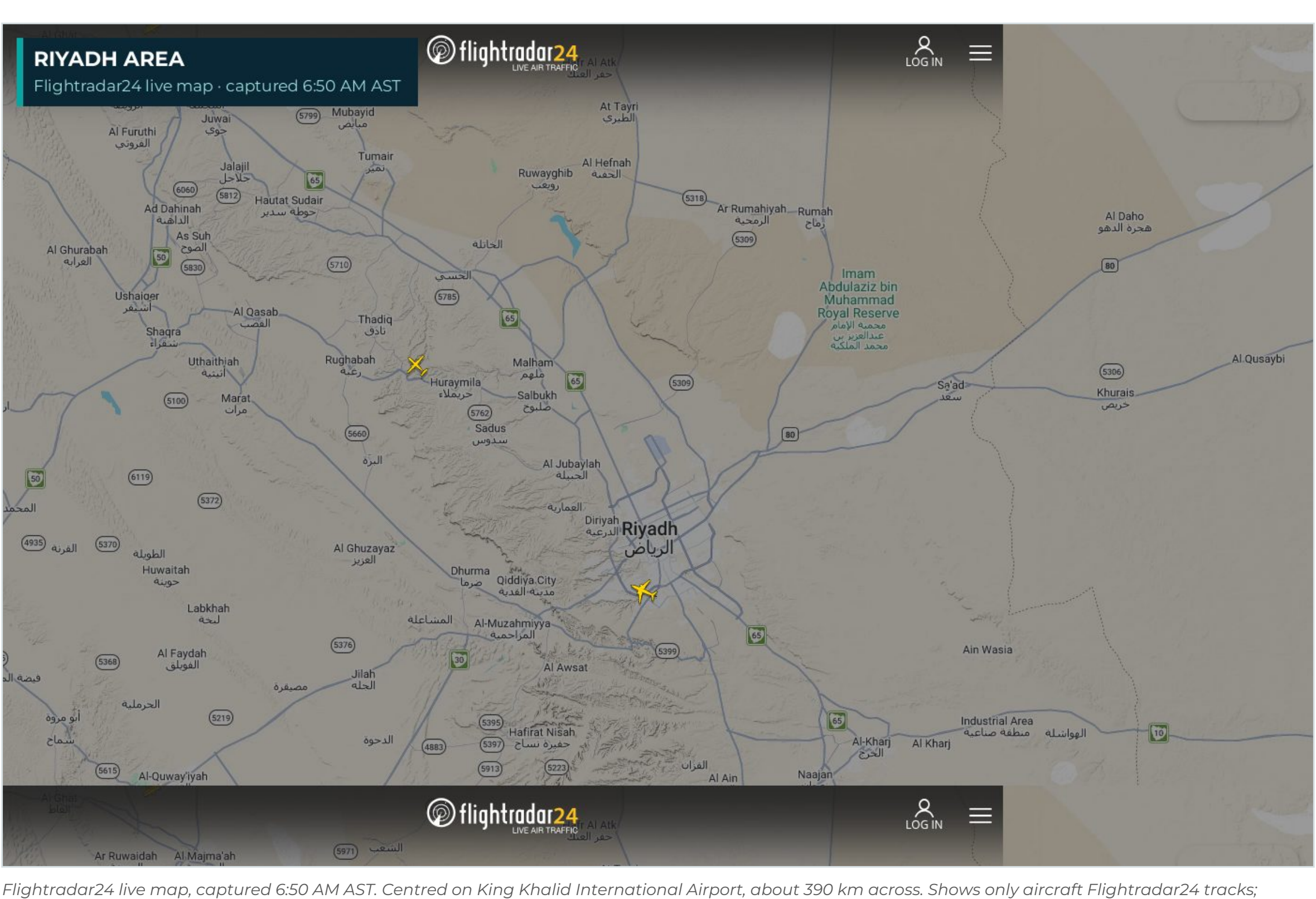
Recorded takeoffs (0) and landings (0) at RUH per hour from 7:00 AM Wednesday to 6:50 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday covers the whole window; the only Riyadh movement in it was SV1523 to Tabuk at 4:11 AM Wednesday.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	4881 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 6:50 AM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

4 Dammam airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 5:14 AM (96 min).

59	1:32 AM	5:14 AM	0	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
29 departures + 30 arrivals, 21% of 284 scheduled.	SV1131 to Jeddah, 317 min before 6:50 AM.	XY704 from Madinah, 96 min before 6:50 AM.	0 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

Cancellation basis: *Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 6:50 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 58 at 6:50 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	29	30	59	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	28 (20%)	30 (21%)	58	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	3 (2%)	6 (4%)	9	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	1 (25%)	6 (50%)	7	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	7 of 21	11 of 26	18 of 47	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	0	0	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	13	11	24	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	45	43	88	FR24 stats panel

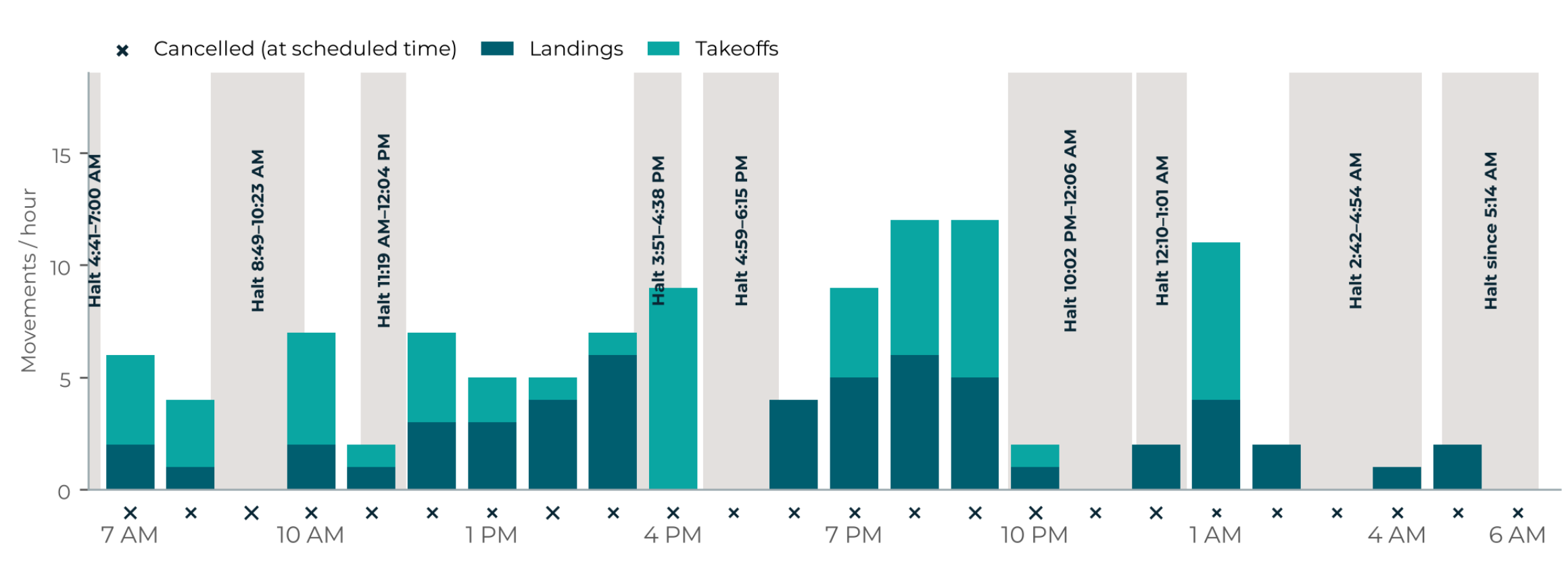
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Emirates	8
Etihad Airways	8
flydubai	8
Egyptair	6
Qatar Airways	6

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Dubai	16
Jeddah	9
Abu Dhabi	8
Cairo	6
Doha	6

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (55) and landings (54) at DMM per hour from 7:00 AM Wednesday to 6:50 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

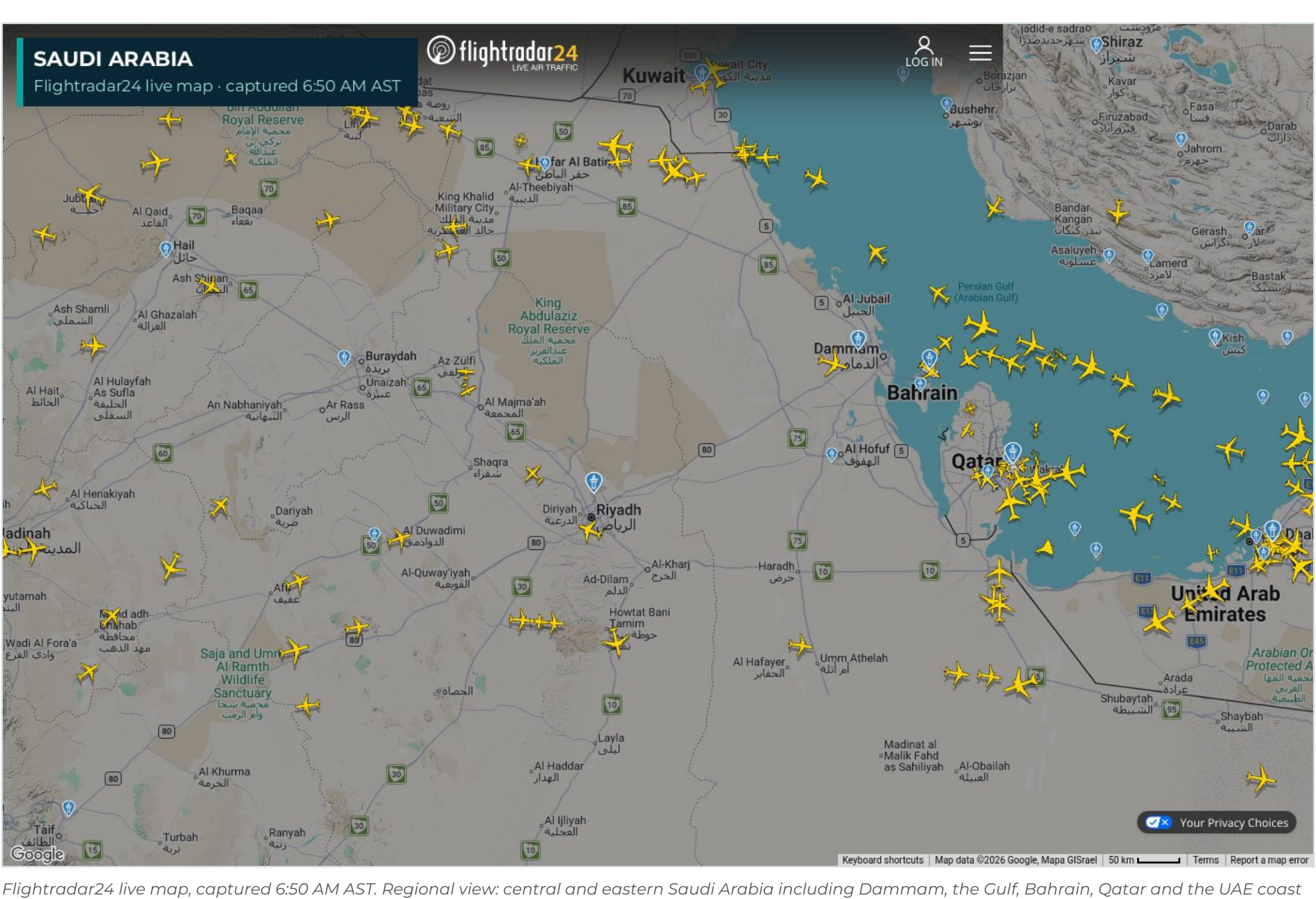
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 5:14 AM	96 min and counting
Halt 2:42–4:54 AM	132 min
Halt 12:10–1:01 AM	50 min
Halt 10:02 PM–12:06 AM	123 min
Halt 4:59–6:15 PM	75 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition's news check (6:50 AM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



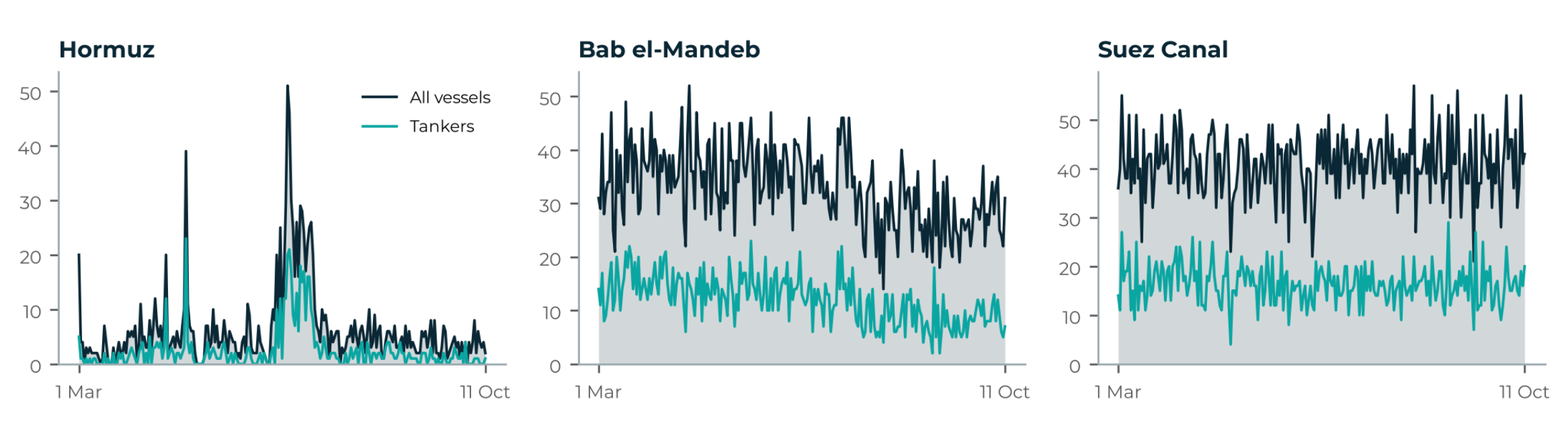
Flightradar24 live map, captured 6:50 AM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

ECONOMY

5 Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

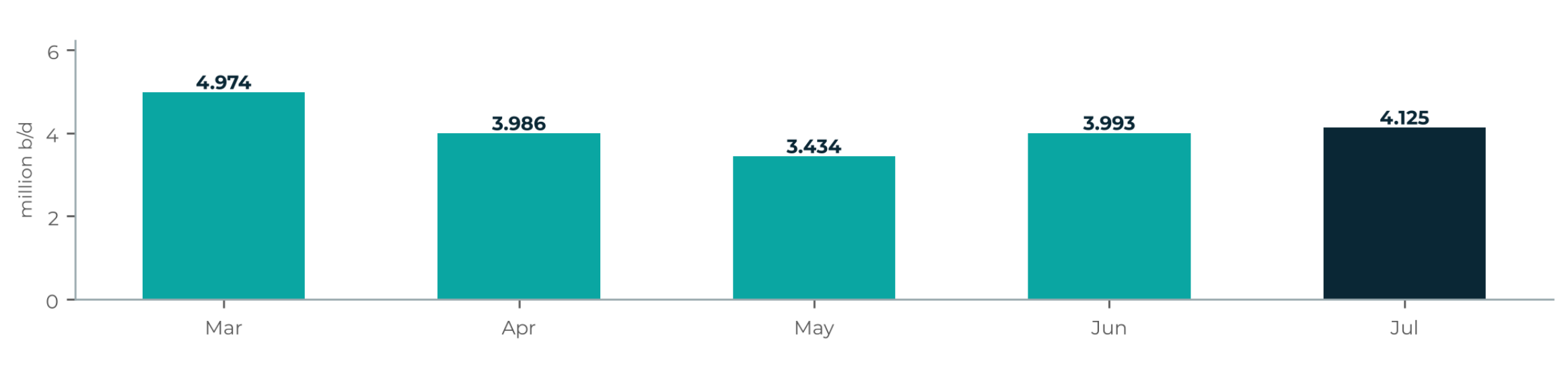
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 11 Oct	**2**	1	1	4.1 (2.7)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 11 Oct	**31**	7	24	28.3 (29.6)
Suez Canal	Sun 11 Oct	**43**	20	23	41.7 (43.1)



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 6:51 AM, Thu 15 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

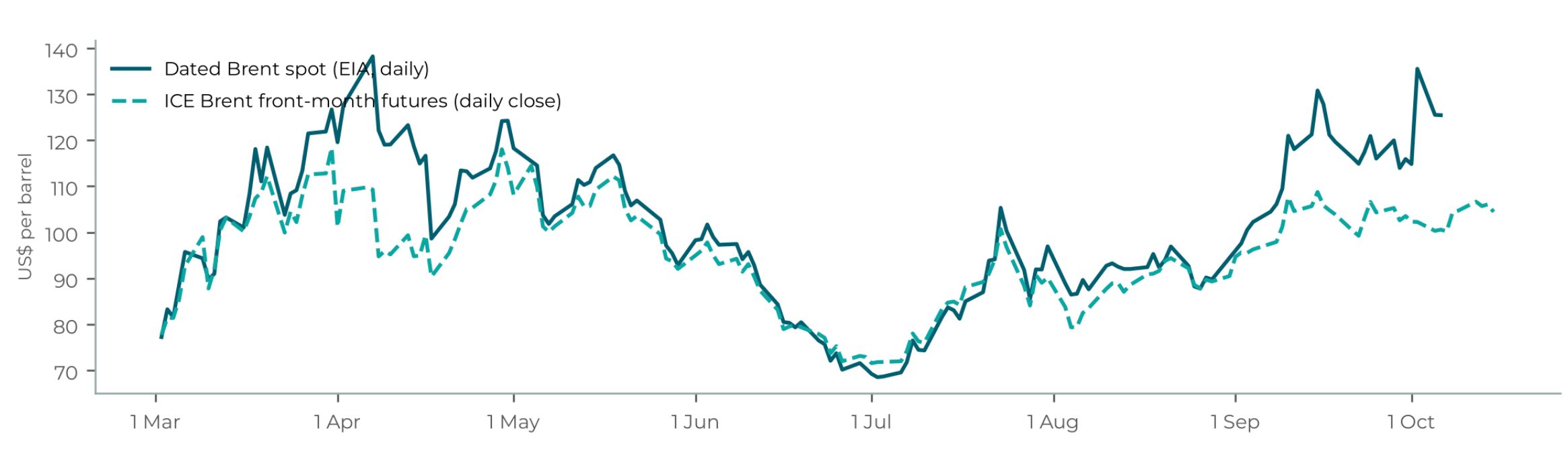


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$104.44	$125.44	+23%	+62%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 6:40 AM, Thu 15 Oct AST (-1.5% on day). Near real time.	Tue 6 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $102.24 on Fri 4 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

METHOD AND LIMITS

6 What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 6:50 AM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
6:50 AM, Thu 15 Oct	6:50 AM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Halted**	Open sources · not official	8:00 AM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 8:00 AM